4 STEPS FOR STUDYING *The Bible*

Inductive Bible Study Method • John 3:16

WHAT DOES IT MEAN?

1. Rational: WHY was this said or placed HERE?

Nicodemus thought physical lineage as a son of Abraham and law-observance earned eternal life. Jesus placed this truth to reveal that salvation requires sovereign spiritual rebirth from above.

2. Implicational: WHAT is the SIGNIFICANCE?

(vv. 3–8), grounded solely in the cross of Christ.

- The scope of God's love is cosmic ("the world"), not just ethnic.
- The cost of God's love is infinite (giving His "only begotten Son").

👑CONTEXT is KING!

Immediate Context: John 3:14–15 (Moses lifting serpent in wilderness)
Satellite Context: John 20:30–31 (Written that you may believe!)

KEY INTERPRETIVE QUESTION:

"Does 'the world' mean all people are automatically saved?"

NO! John 3:18 explicitly qualifies: "Whoever believes is not condemne
but whoever does not believe stands condemned already!"

"The best interpreter of Scripture is Scripture itself in cont

2 Interpretation

WHERE DOES IT FIT?

Correlation helps us connect the dots and see how everything fits together in the grand story of the Bible.

"Using Scriptures to Interpret Scriptures"

Analogy of Faith • Canonical Harmony

JOHN 3:16: WHERE DOES IT FIT?

- **Numbers 21:8–9 — The OT Historical Type**
  Moses raised the bronze serpent on a pole; dying sinners looked in faith and were saved from death (John 3:14–15).
- **Romans 5:8 — The Proof of Sacrificial Love**
  "God demonstrates His own love toward us, in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- **1 John 4:9–10 — The Definition of Love**
  "In this the love of God was made manifest: God sent His only Son into the world so that we might live through Him."
- **Genesis 22:2, 16 — The Moriah Foreshadowing**
  Abraham offered his "only son, whom you love" on the mount; God spared Isaac but did not spare His own Son (Rom 8:32).

3 Correlation

WHAT DO I SEE?

L-A-S-T Framework

Literal form (Genre): Gospel Narrative / Monologue
Historical dialogue between Jesus and Nicodemus at night; theological exposition of God's redemptive purpose.

Atmosphere (tone and mood):
Solemn, deeply compassionate, urgent, life-or-death contrast; abounding in divine grace and supreme divine generosity.

Structure (how words and parts work together):
- Causation / Link: "For" (gar) links to vv. 14–15 (Bronze serpent)
- Manner / Degree: "so loved" (houtōs = in this manner/extent)
- Purpose / Result: "that He gave... that whoever believes"
- Major Contrast: "shall not perish, BUT have eternal life"

Terms / phrases (repeated or emphasized terms):
- "God" (Theos) — Initiator and primary actor
- "Loved" (ēgapēsen) — Unconditional sacrificial commitment
- "The world" (kosmon) — Fallen human realm in rebellion
- "Gave" (edōken) — Voluntary offering of His greatest treasure
- "Only begotten Son" (monogenē) — Unique, one-of-a-kind
- "Whoever believes" (pas ho pisteuōn) — Universal invitation

Detective Principle: "Observation is looking until you see."
Ask W&H questions: Who gave? What was given? To whom? Why?
Condition: What must a person do to not perish? (Believe!)

1 Observation

HOW DOES IT WORK?

Knowing
- Know the text: God loved the world by giving His unique Son to rescue perishing sinners.
- Know yourself: I was helpless and doomed to perish without Christ's finished work.

Relating
Reflect on how these truths influence your relationship with God.
Move from fearful performance into secure, overflowing gratitude as God's beloved child.

Meditating
Time for thinking: Ponder the infinite price the Father paid at Calvary.
"He who did not spare His own Son, how will He not graciously give us all things?" (Rom 8:32)

Practicing

Specific Behavior: Train in godliness (1 Tim 4:7)

SPACEPETS Checklist:
- Sin to confess: Self-reliance & doubting God's love
- Promise to claim: "Shall not perish, but have eternal life"
- Attitude to change: From apathy to Christlike compassion
- Command to obey: Believe on the Son & proclaim Him
- Example to follow: God's sacrificial, giving love
- Prayer to echo: "Lord, thank You for loving me."
- Error to avoid: Universalism (perishing is real!)
- Truth to believe: Eternal life is a present gift in Christ

The 4 P's of Application:
- **Personal:** I will personally renew my resting faith in Christ today and examine my motives.
- **Practical:** I will intentionally share the gospel message of John 3:16 with a beloved colleague this week.
- **Possible:** Attainable by the Holy Spirit's guidance, taking prayerful initiative.
- **Provable:** Measurable by a tangible conversation and prayer journal entry by Sunday.

⚡MY PERSONAL ACTION PLAN FOR JOHN 3:16:
1. Worship: Spend 10 minutes thanking the Father for giving His only Son for me.
2. Evangelism: Write down names of 3 unsaved friends; pray daily and share this verse.
3. Sacrificial Giving: Replicate God's giving by meeting a tangible need of a brother.

4 Application

FANTASTIC FOUR
OBSERVATION • INTERPRETATION • CORRELATION • APPLICATION